

Overview

Linear's marketing canvas is the deepest dark surface in this collection — `{colors.canvas}` is #010102, essentially pure black with a faint blue tint. On top sits a four-step surface ladder (`{colors.surface-1}` through `{colors.surface-4}`) for cards, panels, and lifted tiles, with hairline borders running from `{colors.hairline}` (#23252a) up through `{colors.hairline-strong}` and `{colors.hairline-tertiary}`. Light gray text (`{colors.ink}` #f7f8f8) carries the body and headlines.

The single chromatic accent is **Linear lavender-blue** `{colors.primary}` (#5e6ad2) — used on the brand mark, focus rings, and the primary CTA button. A lighter hover state (`{colors.primary-hover}` #828fff) and a focus-tinted variant (`{colors.primary-focus}` #5e69d1) extend the same hue. Linear avoids saturated greens, oranges, reds, etc. on the marketing canvas — the only semantic color is `{colors.semantic-success}` (#27a644) for status pills and the rare success indicator.

Display type runs Linear's custom sans (with `SF Pro Display` fallback) at weight 500–700 with negative letter-spacing scaling from -3.0px at 80px down to 0 at body. The body family is Linear's text cut, and a Linear Mono is reserved for code snippets in product screenshots.

The page rhythm is **dense product screenshots** — Linear's marketing leads with high-fidelity captures of the product UI (issue list, project view, dashboard) framed in `{colors.surface-1}` panels with `{rounded.xl}` 16px corners. The chrome is intentionally minimal so the app screenshots can do the heavy lifting.

Key Characteristics:

- **Dark-canvas marketing system** — `{colors.canvas}` (#010102) is the deepest dark in this collection.
- **Lavender-blue brand accent** (`{colors.primary}` #5e6ad2) — used scarcely on brand mark, focus, and the primary CTA.
- Four-step surface ladder (canvas → surface-1 → surface-2 → surface-3 → surface-4) carries hierarchy without shadow.
- Display tracking pulls aggressively negative (-3.0px at 80px); body holds at -0.05px.
- Cards use `{rounded.lg}` 12px corners with 1px hairline borders — never pill, rarely 16px.
- **Product UI screenshots** dominate the page. The marketing chrome is a dark frame for the app.
- No second chromatic color. No atmospheric gradients. No spotlight cards.

Colors

> Source pages: linear.app (home), /intake, /pricing, /contact/sales, /build.

Brand & Accent

- **Lavender-Blue** (`{colors.primary}`): The signature Linear accent — primary CTA, brand mark, link emphasis.
- **Lavender Hover** (`{colors.primary-hover}`): Lighter lavender (#828fff) — hovered state of the primary CTA.

- **Lavender Focus** (`{colors.primary-focus}`): Focus-ring tint (#5e69d1) — focused inputs, focused buttons.
- **Brand Secure** (`{colors.brand-secure}`): Muted lavender-gray (#7a7fad) — used in "Linear Security" surfaces.

Surface

- **Canvas** (`{colors.canvas}`): Default page background — #010102, near-pure black with a faint blue tint.
- **Surface 1** (`{colors.surface-1}`): One step above canvas — feature cards, pricing cards, product screenshot panels.
- **Surface 2** (`{colors.surface-2}`): Two steps above — featured pricing card, hovered cards.
- **Surface 3** (`{colors.surface-3}`): Three steps above — line-tertiary backgrounds, sub-nav.
- **Surface 4** (`{colors.surface-4}`): Four steps above — bg-level-3, deepest lifted surface.
- **Hairline** (`{colors.hairline}`): 1px borders on cards and dividers.
- **Hairline Strong** (`{colors.hairline-strong}`): Stronger 1px borders — input focus rings.
- **Hairline Tertiary** (`{colors.hairline-tertiary}`): Tertiary borders for nested surfaces.
- **Inverse Canvas** (`{colors.inverse-canvas}`): Pure white — surface of the inverse pill CTA on a small set of section openers.
- **Inverse Surface 1** (`{colors.inverse-surface-1}`): One step above inverse canvas.
- **Inverse Surface 2** (`{colors.inverse-surface-2}`): Two steps above inverse canvas.

Text

- **Ink** (`{colors.ink}`): All headlines and emphasized body type — light gray #f7f8f8.
- **Ink Muted** (`{colors.ink-muted}`): Secondary type at #d0d6e0 — meta info on hero panels.
- **Ink Subtle** (`{colors.ink-subtle}`): Tertiary type at #8a8f98 — deselected pricing tabs, footer columns.
- **Ink Tertiary** (`{colors.ink-tertiary}`): Quaternary at #62666d — disabled, footnotes.

Semantic

- **Success Green** (`{colors.semantic-success}`): Status pills, success indicators. The only semantic color on marketing.
- **Overlay** (`{colors.semantic-overlay}`): Pure black overlay scrim for modals.

Typography

Font Family

- **Linear Display** — Linear's custom display sans; fallback `SF Pro Display, -apple-system, system-ui, Segoe UI, Roboto`. Carries display-xl through subhead.
- **Linear Text** — Linear's custom text sans (a slightly different cut tuned for body sizes); same fallback stack. Carries body sizes, button labels, captions.
- **Linear Mono** — Linear's custom mono; fallback `ui-monospace, SF Mono, Menlo`. Used for code snippets in product screenshots and for status / ID tokens.

The marketing surface treats Display and Text as one continuous voice; the family change is silent.

Hierarchy

Token	Size	Weight	Line Height	Letter Spacing	Use
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<code>{typography.display-xl}</code>	80px	600	1.05	-3.0px	Largest hero headline
<code>{typography.display-lg}</code>	56px	600	1.10	-1.8px	Section opener headlines
<code>{typography.display-md}</code>	40px	600	1.15	-1.0px	Sub-section headlines
<code>{typography.headline}</code>	28px	600	1.20	-0.6px	Pricing tier titles, CTA banner heading
<code>{typography.card-title}</code>	22px	500	1.25	-0.4px	Feature card title
<code>{typography.subhead}</code>	20px	400	1.40	-0.2px	Lead body, intro paragraphs
<code>{typography.body-lg}</code>	18px	400	1.50	-0.1px	Hero subhead, lead paragraphs
<code>{typography.body}</code>	16px	400	1.50	-0.05px	Default body
<code>{typography.body-sm}</code>	14px	400	1.50	0	Card body, footer columns
<code>{typography.caption}</code>	12px	400	1.40	0	Captions, meta, status
<code>{typography.button}</code>	14px	500	1.20	0	All button labels
<code>{typography.eyebrow}</code>	13px	500	1.30	0.4px	Section eyebrow (slight positive tracking)
<code>{typography.mono}</code>	13px	400	1.50	0	Linear Mono for code in product screenshots

Principles

- **Aggressive negative tracking on display** (-3.0px at 80px $\approx$ 4% of size).
- **Single voice from display to body.** Display-xl at 600 $\rightarrow$ body at 400 — same family, narrower weights.
- **Eyebrow uses positive tracking** (+0.4px) — contrast against the negative-tracked display marks the eyebrow as taxonomy.
- **Mono only in code contexts.** Linear Mono lives inside product screenshots — not on marketing chrome.

Note on Font Substitutes

Linear's custom typeface isn't publicly distributed; the documented fallback `'SF Pro Display, -apple-system, system-ui'` is the recommended substitute on macOS. For cross-platform implementation, **Inter** at weight 500 / 600 / 700 is the closest free substitute. **Geist Sans** is also viable. For mono, **JetBrains Mono** or **Geist Mono** at weight 400 closely approximates Linear Mono.

Layout

Spacing System

- **Base unit**: 4px.
- **Tokens (front matter)**: `{spacing.xxs}` 4px · `{spacing.xs}` 8px · `{spacing.sm}` 12px · `{spacing.md}` 16px · `{spacing.lg}` 24px · `{spacing.xl}` 32px · `{spacing.xxl}` 48px · `{spacing.section}` 96px.
- Card interior padding: `{spacing.lg}` 24px on feature/pricing cards; `{spacing.xl}` 32px on testimonial cards; `{spacing.xxl}` 48px on CTA banners.

- Pill button padding: 8px vertical · 14px horizontal — Linear's compact button spec.
- Form input padding: 8px vertical · 12px horizontal.

Grid & Container

- Max content width sits around 1280px.
- Card grids are 3-up at desktop, 2-up at tablet, 1-up at mobile.
- Pricing tier grid is 3-up; comparison strip below shows checkmarks per tier.
- Product screenshot panels span full content width — they're the protagonist.

Whitespace Philosophy

The dark canvas IS the whitespace. Sections separate by lift onto surface-1 panels, not by gaps in white. Within a panel, generous `{spacing.lg}` 24px gaps between content blocks; `{spacing.section}` 96px between sections.

Elevation & Depth

Level	Treatment	Use
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0 (flat)	No shadow, no border	Default for body type, hero text, footer
1 (charcoal lift)	<code>{colors.surface-1}</code> background on canvas, 1px <code>{colors.hairline}</code>	Default cards, product panels
2 (surface-2 lift)	<code>{colors.surface-2}</code> background, 1px <code>{colors.hairline-strong}</code>	Featured pricing card, hovered cards
3 (surface-3 lift)	<code>{colors.surface-3}</code> background	Sub-nav, dropdown menus
4 (focus ring)	2px <code>{colors.primary-focus}</code> outline at 50% opacity	Focused input, focused button

Linear's depth is carried by surface ladder + hairline borders. The brand resists drop shadows on dark almost entirely.

Decorative Depth

- **Product UI screenshots** dominate as decorative depth.
- **No atmospheric gradients, no spotlight cards.**
- **Subtle white edge highlight** on the top edge of lifted panels — gives the dark surface a faint "pixel rendered" feel.

Shapes

Border Radius Scale

Token	Value	Use
--- --- ---		
<code>{rounded.xs}</code>	4px	Small chips, status badges
<code>{rounded.sm}</code>	6px	Inline tags
<code>{rounded.md}</code>	8px	All buttons, form inputs

`{rounded.lg}`	12px	Pricing cards, feature cards, testimonial cards
`{rounded.xl}`	16px	Product screenshot panels
`{rounded.xxl}`	24px	Oversized CTA banners (rare)
`{rounded.pill}`	9999px	Pricing tab toggles, status pills
`{rounded.full}`	9999px	Avatar circles

Photography & Illustration Geometry

- Product UI screenshots dominate; they sit in `{rounded.xl}` 16px tiles with `{spacing.lg}` 24px outer padding.
- Customer logo tiles render at small sizes (~24px logo height) on `{colors.canvas}` with no border.
- Avatar circles in testimonial cards use `{rounded.full}` at 32–40px sizes.

Components

Buttons

`button-primary` — Lavender CTA. The default primary CTA across all pages.

- Background `{colors.primary}`, text `{colors.on-primary}`, type `{typography.button}`, padding 8px 14px, rounded `{rounded.md}`.
- Pressed state lives in `button-primary-pressed` (background shifts to `{colors.primary-focus}`).
- Hover state lives in `button-primary-hover` (background shifts to `{colors.primary-hover}` lighter lavender).

`button-secondary` — Charcoal button. Used for secondary CTAs ("Sign in", "Read changelog").

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.button}`, padding 8px 14px, rounded `{rounded.md}`. 1px `{colors.hairline}` border.

`button-tertiary` — Plain text button.

- Background `{colors.canvas}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.button}`, rounded `{rounded.md}`, padding 8px 14px.

`button-inverse` — White-on-dark inverse CTA.

- Background `{colors.inverse-canvas}`, text `{colors.inverse-ink}`, type `{typography.button}`, rounded `{rounded.md}`, padding 8px 14px.

Pricing Tabs

`pricing-tab-default` + ***`pricing-tab-selected`*** — Pill-toggle on `/pricing`.

- Default: `{colors.canvas}` background, `{colors.ink-subtle}` text, rounded `{rounded.pill}`, padding 6px 14px.
- Selected: `{colors.surface-2}` background, `{colors.ink}` text — selected = surface lift.

Cards & Containers

****`pricing-card`**** — Each tier on `/pricing`.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body}`, rounded `{rounded.lg}`, padding 24px. 1px `{colors.hairline}` border.

****`pricing-card-featured`**** — Recommended tier — surface lift to surface-2.

- Background `{colors.surface-2}`, otherwise identical structure.

****`feature-card`**** — Generic feature highlight tile.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body}`, rounded `{rounded.lg}`, padding 24px.

****`product-screenshot-card`**** — The dominant card type — frames a high-fidelity Linear app UI screenshot.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body}`, rounded `{rounded.xl}`, padding 24px.

****`testimonial-card`**** — Customer quote with avatar + name + role.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body-lg}`, rounded `{rounded.lg}`, padding 32px.

****`customer-logo-tile`**** — Small tile in the customer marquee.

- Background `{colors.canvas}`, text `{colors.ink-subtle}`, type `{typography.caption}`, rounded `{rounded.xs}`, padding 16px.

****`cta-banner`**** — Closing CTA panel near page bottom.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.headline}`, rounded `{rounded.lg}`, padding 48px.

Inputs & Forms

****`text-input`** + **`text-input-focused`**** — Form fields on `/contact/sales` and signup overlays.

- Background `{colors.surface-1}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body}`, rounded `{rounded.md}`, padding 8px 12px.

- Focused state retains the same surface; the focus ring is a 2px `{colors.primary-focus}` outline at 50% opacity.

Status & Build Page

****`changelog-row`**** — Each row in `/build` (changelog page) listing version, date, and changes.

- Background `{colors.canvas}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body}`, rounded `{rounded.xs}`, padding 24px 0. 1px `{colors.hairline}` bottom rule.

****`status-badge`**** — Small status pill.

- Background `{colors.surface-2}`, text `{colors.ink-muted}`, type `{typography.caption}`, rounded `{rounded.pill}`, padding 2px 8px.

Navigation

****`top-nav`**** — Sticky dark bar with the Linear wordmark left, primary nav links centered, and a `button-secondary` ("Sign in") + `button-primary` ("Get started") pair right.

- Background `{colors.canvas}`, text `{colors.ink}`, type `{typography.body-sm}`, height 56px.

Footer

****`footer`**** — Dense link grid on `{colors.canvas}` with the Linear wordmark left.

- Background `{colors.canvas}`, text `{colors.ink-subtle}`, type `{typography.caption}`, padding 64px 32px.

Do's and Don'ts

Do

- Reserve `{colors.canvas}` (#010102) as the system's anchor surface — the faint blue tint is intentional.
- Use `{colors.primary}` lavender ONLY for: brand mark, primary CTA, focus ring, link emphasis.
- Use the four-step surface ladder for hierarchy. Avoid skipping levels.
- Pair display weight 600 with body weight 400 — Linear resists 700+ display weights.
- Apply negative letter-spacing aggressively on display.
- Use product UI screenshots as the protagonist of every section.
- Compose CTAs as `{rounded.md}` 8px corners.

Don't

- Don't ship a light-mode marketing page.
- Don't use lavender as a section background or card fill.
- Don't introduce a second chromatic accent (orange, pink, green for marketing).
- Don't add atmospheric gradients or spotlight cards.
- Don't pill-round CTAs.
- Don't use `#000000` true black as the canvas.
- Don't combine multiple bright accents in product screenshot mockups.

Responsive Behavior

Breakpoints

Name	Width	Key Changes
Desktop-XL	1440px	Default desktop layout
Desktop	1280px	Card grid 3-up maintained
Tablet	1024px	Card grid 3-up → 2-up
Mobile-Lg	768px	Pricing comparison becomes accordion; nav hamburger
Mobile	480px	Single-column; display-xl scales 80px → ~36px

Touch Targets

- CTAs hold ≥ 40 px tap height across viewports.
- Pricing tab pills hold ≥ 36 px tap height; touch viewports grow to ≥ 44 px.
- Form inputs hold ≥ 44 px tap target on touch.

Collapsing Strategy

- **Top nav**: links collapse to hamburger below 768px.
- **Card grids**: 3-up $\rightarrow$ 2-up at 1024px $\rightarrow$ 1-up below 768px.
- **Pricing comparison**: per-tier accordion below 768px.
- **Display type**: `{typography.display-xl}` 80px scales toward `{typography.display-md}` 40px on mobile.

Image Behavior

- Product UI screenshots maintain aspect ratio and never crop.
- Customer logos in the marquee may collapse from 6-up to 3-up below 768px.

Iteration Guide

1. Focus on ONE component at a time and reference it by its `components:` token name.
2. When introducing a section, decide first which surface lift it lives on.
3. Default body to `{typography.body}` at weight 400.
4. Run `npx @google/design.md lint DESIGN.md` after edits.
5. Add new variants as separate component entries.
6. Treat lavender as scarce: brand mark, primary CTA, focus, link emphasis.
7. Lead every section with a product UI screenshot.

Known Gaps

- The four-step surface ladder values are extracted directly from Linear's `--color-bg-level-3`, `--color-line-tint`, etc. CSS variables; they are Linear's canonical surface spec.
- Form-field error and validation styling is not visible on the inspected pages.
- Light mode is not documented because the marketing site does not ship a light theme.
- Linear's actual product UI uses a richer color-tag palette (red, orange, yellow, green, blue, purple) for issue priorities and project labels — those colors live in the in-product surfaces shown in mockups.
- The custom display, text, and mono families are proprietary; an open-source substitute is acceptable.